# Daniel E. Finol-González

**Computer & Data Scientist · Python · Machine Learning · Spanish (native) / English (C2)** Santiago, Chile · +56 9 4564 6658 · danielfinol@gmail.com · linkedin.com/in/danielfinol · danielfinol.github.io

## Summary

Computer scientist with an MSc in Applied Computer Science (97.8% average) and published machine-learning research. Taught graduate courses in machine learning, statistics, math and algorithms for 13 years, and Python and data science in Chile. Industry experience programming surveys at Ipsos in a fast-turnaround, English-language environment. Known for explaining complex technical ideas clearly to technical and non-technical audiences.

## Skills

- **Programming:** Python (pandas, scikit-learn), C, MATLAB/Octave; SQL (Ipsos, bootcamps; SQL Server and Access at Chevron); full-stack Python (bootcamp)
- **Data science & ML:** supervised and unsupervised learning, neural networks, ensemble and surrogate models (Kriging, RBF, polynomial regression), statistical methods, stochastic models, time-series features, optimization
- **Assessed (DataCamp, 2020):** Python Programming 99th percentile · Machine Learning Fundamentals in Python 98th · Understanding and Interpreting Data 100th
- **Languages:** Spanish (native) · English C2 (EF SET 95/100; two years of US high school) · French (DELF A1–A4)

## Experience

**Teacher, Python Programming & Data Science** — Universidad Alberto Hurtado, Santiago · Mar–Aug 2026

- **Fundamentals of Data Science** (engineering core): end-to-end projects in Python and Jupyter covering data cleaning and exploration, regression, feature engineering and PCA, classification metrics (incl. confusion matrix) and class imbalance, data visualization and KPI reporting, and data ethics.
- **Fundamentals of Programming:** algorithmic thinking, structured programming and basic data structures in Python.

**Senior Script Writer** — Ipsos Interactive Services, Chile · Aug 2021–Aug 2022

- Programmed online market-research surveys in Dimensions, supported system administration.
- Delivered fast-turnaround projects in parallel inside a global, English-language organization.

**Teaching Assistant** — Neuromatch Academy (remote) · Deep Learning, Aug 2021 · Computational Neuroscience (projects), Jul 2021

- Facilitated small-group work for international students in intensive online courses.

**Instructor, Introduction to Programming** — Minor in AI + Law, Universidad Autónoma de Chile · 2020, 2021

- Taught Python programming to law students, a non-technical audience.

**Aggregate Professor** — MSc in Applied Computer Science, Universidad del Zulia, Venezuela · 2005–2018

- Taught Neural Networks (Machine Learning), Statistical Methods, Stochastic Models, Data Structures & Algorithms, Programming Techniques and Mathematics for Computer Science.
- Lead researcher on the funded project "Optimizing Functions Using Multiple Surrogate Models" (CONDES, 2008–2009), published in a SciELO-indexed journal.
- Secretary of the Technical Council, Institute of Applied Calculus (2013–2018).

**Intern, Analysis & Development** — Chevron · 2000 (Access, SQL Server)

## Education

- **MSc in Applied Computer Science** — Universidad del Zulia, 2006 · Average 19.56/20 (97.8%) · Thesis: global optimization through an adaptive ensemble of surrogate models
- **BSc in Computer Science** — Universidad del Zulia, 2001 · Ranked 1st in the School of Sciences class of 2001 · Thesis: iterated-adjustments method for multidimensional scaling (in C)

## Applied projects, awards & publications

- **Alan Turing Institute Data Study Group** (2021): team project on predictive maintenance from machining-sensor data for the AMRC, using time-series and spectral features in Python.
- **Bootcamps:** Data Science (180 h, Aspasia/SOFOFA/SENCE, 2023) · Full-Stack Python (Coding Dojo black belt, Talento Digital para Chile, 2021).
- **Competitive programming:** 1st place, ACM South American Regional Elimination, Caracas 1998; 2nd place, National University Programming Marathon, 1998.
- **Publications:** 8 papers and book chapters on machine learning and on AI, big data and intellectual property (Scopus/WoS/SciELO-indexed journals; publishers incl. La Ley, Tirant Lo Blanch, Thomson Reuters). Second prize, XI ASEDA Award, Madrid, 2017.

## Courses

- **ML & AI:** Stanford Intro to AI (Thrun & Norvig, top 1%, 2011) · Stanford Machine Learning (Ng, 2011) · deeplearning.ai, 3 deep-learning courses (2018) · Hinton's Neural Networks for ML (2019) · Inria scikit-learn (2022)
- **Recent:** Kaggle + Google Gen AI Intensive (2024) · BlueDot AI Alignment Fast-Track (2024) · Neuromatch NeuroAI, 85 h (2024) · AI Safety Collab (2025)
- **Plus 30+ MOOCs** in algorithms, statistics, R, time series, calculus and computational neuroscience (Coursera, edX, DataCamp).